

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. The ABC model: what attitude is made of

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1. The ABC model: what attitude is made of

[1] Attitude is a stable evaluative disposition toward a specific object.

|
v

[2] The cognitive component holds beliefs and knowledge about the object.

|
v

[3] The affective component carries emotional charge, positive or negative.

|
v

[4] The behavioural component is the predisposition to act toward the object.

|
v

[5] Attitude is object-specific; value is general and cross-situational.

|
v

[6] Belief is a single cognitive claim; attitude is an evaluative stance.

|
v

[7] Aptitude is the trainable capacity to perform a role well.

|
v

[8] The ABC model is associated with Rosenberg and Hovland, 1960.

|
v

VERDICT -> Attitude has three components; confusing it with value or aptitude costs marks.

ANSWER USE -> Open any attitude question by defining the ABC model and distinguishing it from value.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. How attitudes form: experience, learning, reinforcement

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2. How attitudes form: experience, learning, reinforcement

[1] Direct experience with an object creates the strongest initial attitude.

|
v

[2] Social learning from family, peers and media shapes evaluative tendencies.

|
v

[3] Reinforcement through repeated outcomes attaches evaluative charge.

|
v

[4] Two officers in the same office can hold opposite attitudes toward the same community.

|
v

[5] Formation explains attitude but does not justify it ethically.

|
v

[6] Training can intervene at any formation pathway to reshape attitude.

|
v

[7] The affective component often resists change even when beliefs shift.

|
v

[8] Institutional incentives can reinforce or corrode attitudes over time.

|
v

VERDICT -> Attitudes are formed, not born; understanding formation identifies training targets.

ANSWER USE -> Explain why attitudes differ before prescribing a change mechanism.

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3. Hovland-Yale persuasion: source, message, audience, channel

[1] The communicator's credibility and expertise determine source effect.

|
v

[2] The message's content, framing and emotional tone shape reception.

|
v

[3] The audience's predispositions determine resistance or openness.

|
v

[4] The channel or medium was added later from wider communication research.

|
v

[5] ASHA workers delivering vernacular vaccination messages illustrate source credibility.

|
v

[6] A gazette notification to illiterate beneficiaries shows audience-channel mismatch.

|
v

[7] Algorithmic micro-targeting transforms the audience variable at scale.

|
v

VERDICT -> Effective persuasion activates all variables; the channel is not part of the original Yale triad.

ANSWER USE -> Structure any persuasion or campaign-effectiveness answer around these four variables.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: 4. Cognitive dissonance: three paths, one ethical risk

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4. Cognitive dissonance: three paths, one ethical risk

[1] Dissonance arises when behaviour contradicts a held attitude.

|
v

[2] Path A: change the attitude to match the behaviour.

|
v

[3] Path B: change future behaviour to match the attitude.

|
v

[4] Path C: add a self-justifying cognition, the rationalisation path.

|
v

[5] Path C is the ethically dangerous one in administration.

|
v

[6] Small compromises rationalised once consolidate into settled practice.

|
v

[7] Ethics review and peer accountability interrupt the rationalisation cycle.

|
v

[8] Whistleblower protection supports officers who choose Path B.

|
v

VERDICT -> Rationalisation, not dissonance itself, is the ethical risk multiplier.

ANSWER USE -> Use the three-path framework whenever a question involves value erosion or corruption creep.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: 5. The attitude-behaviour gap: why good attitudes fail

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5. The attitude-behaviour gap: why good attitudes fail

[1] LaPiere's 1934 study showed stated attitudes predicted specific acts poorly.

|
v

[2] Situational pressure can override even strongly held positive attitudes.

|
v

[3] Institutional incentives may reward conduct that contradicts declared values.

|
v

[4] Social norms in an office can normalise conduct that individuals privately oppose.

|
v

[5] RTI mandates are a binding external constraint closing the transparency gap.

|
v

[6] Audit trails make discretionary acts accountable to evidence.

|
v

[7] Whistleblower protection reduces the cost of acting on principled attitudes.

|
v

[8] Attitude is necessary but insufficient; institutional design is the bridge.

|
v

VERDICT -> Close the gap with institutional constraint, not more exhortation.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the limitation paragraph in any answer that praises attitude change.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Persuasion, manipulation and propaganda: the ethical spectrum

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6. Persuasion, manipulation and propaganda: the ethical spectrum

[1] Persuasion respects audience autonomy and relies on truthful argument.

|
v

[2] Manipulation exploits cognitive biases or conceals intent.

|
v

[3] Propaganda uses repetition and emotional framing at scale to bypass critical evaluation.

|
v

[4] Swachh Bharat wall paintings with identified sponsorship are legitimate persuasion.

|
v

[5] Undisclosed paid influencers suppressing criticism cross the manipulation line.

|
v

[6] Fear-based state campaigns without disclosure shade toward propaganda.

|
v

[7] The ethical test is transparency of intent and audience autonomy.

|
v

[8] The same digital channel enables both legitimate information and disinformation.

|
v

VERDICT -> Label the practice precisely: persuasion, manipulation or propaganda, then justify.

ANSWER USE -> Apply this spectrum to any social-media, campaign or information-governance question.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Moral attitude versus political attitude

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7. Moral attitude versus political attitude

[1] Moral attitude judges right and wrong across contexts; it must be retained.

|
v

[2] Political attitude evaluates parties and power contests; it must be bracketed.

|
v

[3] CCS Conduct Rules 1964, Rule 5 restricts political participation.

|
v

[4] CCS Conduct Rules 1964, Rule 7 restricts election canvassing.

|
v

[5] Non-partisanship covers official conduct, not private belief or voting.

|
v

[6] Policy awareness and candid briefing are duties, not partisan acts.

|
v

[7] Moral objection framed in law and public interest is principled dissent.

|
v

VERDICT -> Retain moral judgement; bracket political preference; distinguish duty from partisanship.

ANSWER USE -> Use whenever a question tests impartiality, neutrality or the limits of official conduct.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Positive versus negative mindset in rule interpretation

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8. Positive versus negative mindset in rule interpretation

[1] A positive mindset reads rules with their public purpose in view.

|
v

[2] A negative mindset treats rules as obstacles or sources of discretionary power.

|
v

[3] A facilitative officer helps correct a curable document error.

|
v

[4] A cynical officer exploits ambiguity to demand informal payment.

|
v

[5] Positive interpretation enables fair access without ignoring mandatory conditions.

|
v

[6] Negative interpretation produces delay, denial and extraction.

|
v

[7] Stress amplifies the dominant mindset in crisis situations.

|
v

[8] Purposive but accountable reading avoids both literalism and arbitrary benevolence.

|
v

VERDICT -> Read rules with purpose, apply with accountability, explain with reasons.

ANSWER USE -> Apply this dual-lens to any question about discretion, mindset or citizen-facing service.

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9. Attitude malleability: William James and training design

[1] The malleability principle holds that attitudes are revisable, not fixed.

|
v

[2] Reflection, field immersion and mentoring reshape evaluative stances.

|
v

[3] Mission Karmayogi modules target cognitive and affective components.

|
v

[4] Foundation-course immersion in underserved communities builds empathy.

|
v

[5] Malleability is not victim-blaming: structural constraints need structural reform.

|
v

[6] Periodic refresher training prevents cynicism and value erosion.

|
v

[7] Provenance caution: the attributed William James sentence is not traceable to his writings.

|
v

VERDICT -> Attitudes can be changed; the change endures only with institutional reinforcement.

ANSWER USE -> Use for any question about training, attitude change, or the William James quotation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. Institutional closure: codes, constraints and the residual gap

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10. Institutional closure: codes, constraints and the residual gap

[1] Persuasion-based reform is slower but more durable once internalised.

|
v

[2] Rule-based constraint is faster but risks box-ticking compliance.

|
v

[3] Code of ethics targets internalised commitment; code of conduct targets external compliance.

|
v

[4] RTI, audit trails and whistleblower protection are binding constraints.

|
v

[5] Training without institutional reform becomes a box-ticking exercise.

|
v

[6] Institutional constraint without attitude change reverts when monitoring relaxes.

|
v

[7] The administrator must calibrate both strategies to the governance context.

|
v

[8] Durable ethical conduct requires values contained within institutions.

|
v

VERDICT -> Neither persuasion alone nor constraint alone suffices; both must be calibrated together.

ANSWER USE -> Close any attitude-change answer with the institutional-closure qualification.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Trap detection: what costs marks in attitude questions

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11. Trap detection: what costs marks in attitude questions

[1] Attitude and value are related but not identical: value is broader.

|
v

[2] Positive attitude does not guarantee ethical behaviour: gap exists.

|
v

[3] Persuasion is not inherently unethical: it depends on truthfulness.

|
v

[4] Strong attitude does not always predict behaviour: situational override.

|
v

[5] Dissonance is not always resolved ethically: rationalisation is common.

|
v

[6] Persuasion and manipulation are not ethically identical: autonomy differs.

|
v

[7] Channel is not part of the original Hovland-Yale 1953 triad.

|
v

[8] Non-partisanship does not require enforced political blankness of mind.

|
v

VERDICT -> The trap is always an absolute claim where the correct position is qualified.

ANSWER USE -> Scan each MCQ option for unqualified absolutes before selecting the answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 12. PYQ synthesis and answer architecture

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12. PYQ synthesis and answer architecture

[1] 2020 Q4(b) tested positive attitude under stress: use ABC model and crisis example.

|
v

[2] 2021 Q4(a) tested building suitable attitude: use formation pathways and training design.

|
v

[3] 2022 Q2(a) tested positive versus negative mindset: use dual-lens rule-interpretation frame.

|
v

[4] 2025 Q3(b) tested William James malleability: use provenance caution and institutional support.

|
v

[5] 2025 Q1(a) tested social-media ethics: use persuasion-at-scale and Hovland-Yale variables.

|
v

[6] Define attitude via ABC before applying it to the scenario.

|
v

[7] Always note the attitude-behaviour gap as a qualification.

|
v

VERDICT -> Every attitude answer moves from definition to mechanism, example, gap and institutional closure.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the final revision checklist before writing any GS-IV attitude answer.